THE BOY WHO PAINTED DREAMS



Created by Hamidreza Rostami

Leo loved to paint.
He painted in the morning.
He painted in the afternoon.
He even painted at night,
when he was supposed
to be sleeping.

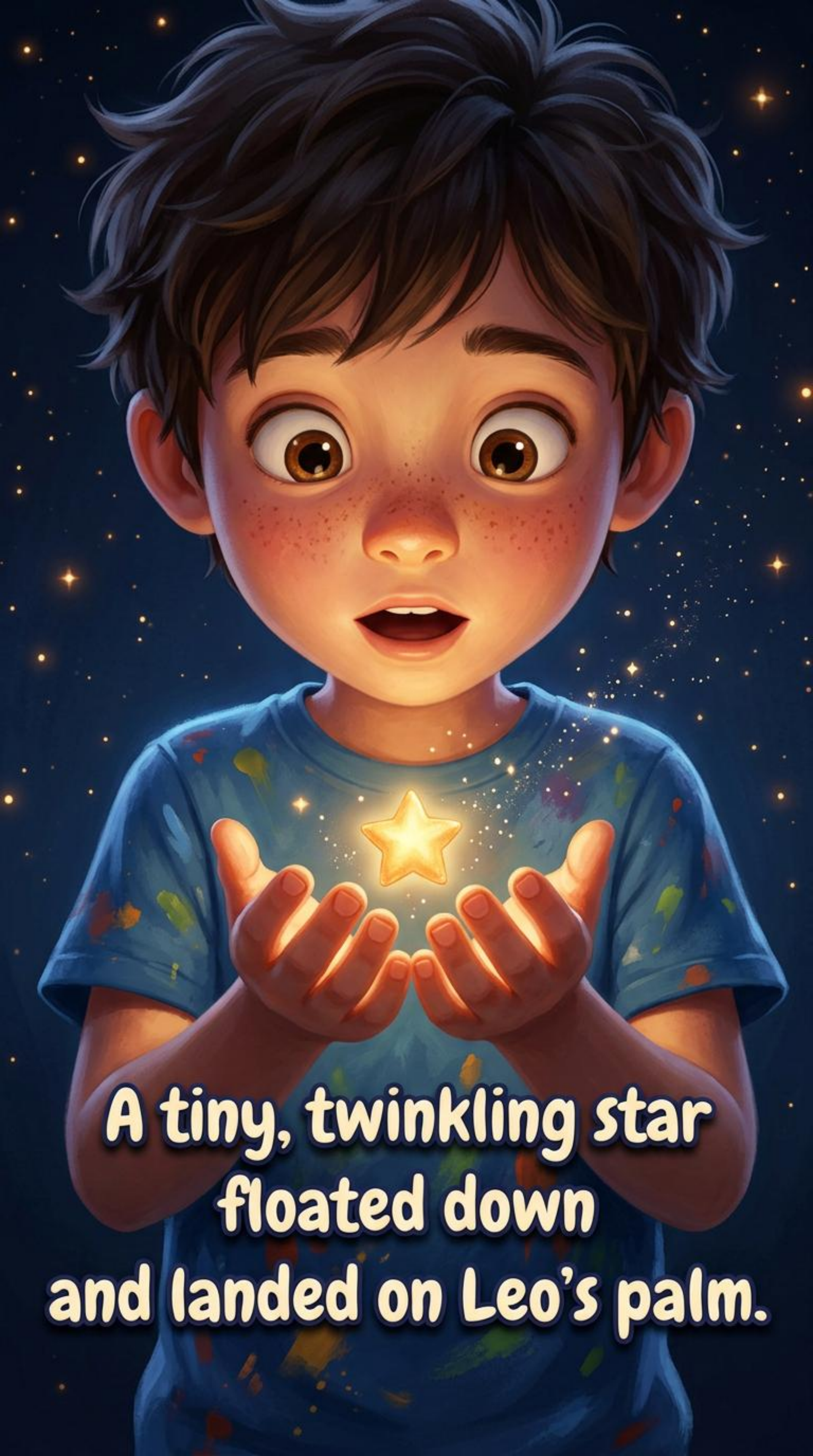


His room was covered in paintings. On the walls, on the floor, even on the ceiling, though his mom did not know about that one.


One night, as Leo was painting
a starry sky on his ceiling,
he had a strange feeling.
His paintbrush felt different.
Lighter. Almost magical.

He looked at it closely.
The bristles were shimmering,
like they were dusted
with stardust.

Leo dipped his brush into the paint
and touched it to the ceiling.
The paint did not just stay
on the ceiling. It lifted off.
It swirled. It became real.


A tiny, twinkling star
floated down
and landed on Leo's palm.

Leo gasped.
“Did I just do that?”

He painted another star.
And another. Soon,
his ceiling was a real starry
sky, with tiny stars
twinkling and dancing.


Leo could not stop.
He painted a crescent moon.
It hung in the air,
glowing softly.


He painted a few clouds.
They floated across his
room like real clouds.



He painted a little house.
It sat on his dresser,
complete with a tiny chimney
and smoke.


Then Leo had an idea.
A big idea.

He painted a door on his wall. A beautiful wooden door with a brass knob. And when he turned the knob, the door opened.

Beyond the door was a world of dreams. There were talking animals. Flying fish. Trees that grew candy. Rivers that flowed with lemonade.


Leo stepped through the door
and into the dream world.


“Welcome, Leo!” said a small, purple elephant with sparkly wings.
“We have been waiting for you,” said a green giraffe with polka dots.



Leo looked around.
“This is my painting!”
The elephant nodded.
“You painted us.
And now we are real!”


Leo spent the night exploring his dream world. He rode on the back of a flying turtle. He ate candy from the trees. He drank lemonade from the rivers. He even taught the polka-dot giraffe how to paint.



Leo loves to paint so much that his bedroom is covered in pictures, right up the ceiling. Then one night his paintbrush starts to shimmer, and the stars he paints lift off the wall and become real.

A dreamy story about imagination, wonder, and discovering that the worlds you make are always waiting for you to come back.

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